



AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: BATH & BODY WORKS

SUMMARY PRESENTATION

10 APRIL 2026

SHIPYARD × Bath & Body Works®

RISE OF “ZERO-CLICK”

When AI Overviews appear in search results:

58%

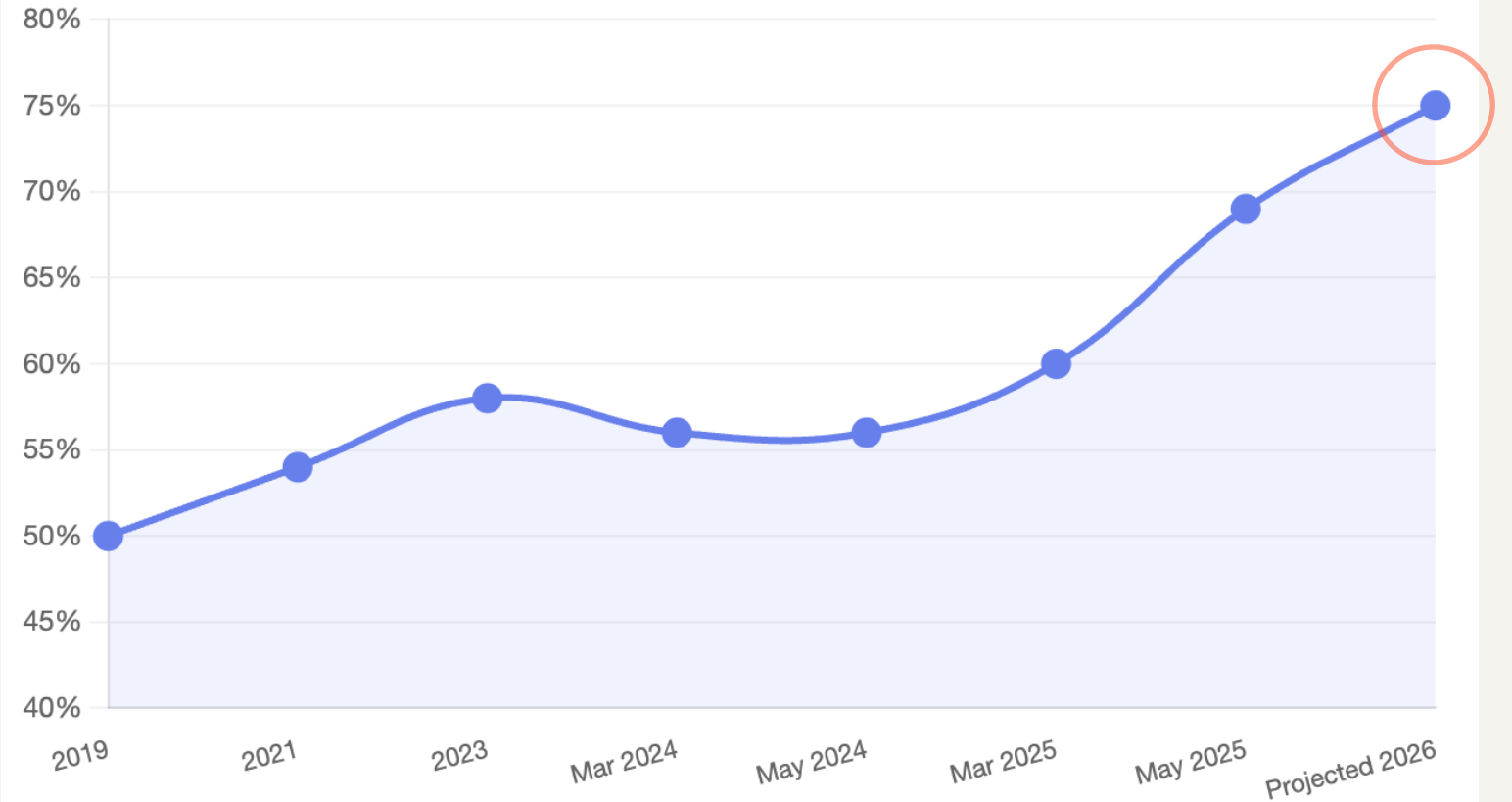
Result in zero click



75%

Expected by end of 2026

Percentage of Google Zero-Click Searches



[Search Engine Land](#)

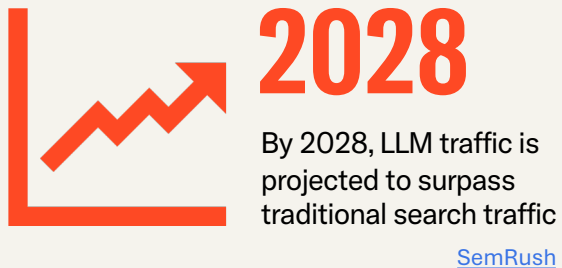
PEOPLE NO LONGER SEARCH, THEY ASK

AI Search Overviews

- Search engines (Google, Bing, etc.) now provide an overview generated by AI, not just links.

AI Models

- LLMs (Large Language Models)
- Separate website, chatbot or app



what is bath & body works brand story?



AI Mode **All** Shopping Images Short videos News Videos More Tools

AI Overview

Bath & Body Works was founded in 1990 in New Albany, Ohio, as a specialty personal care brand under L Brands, opening its first store in a Cambridge, Massachusetts mall. It aimed to offer affordable, high-quality home fragrance and bath products, quickly becoming known for its unique scents, sensory experience, and "giftability". [Wikipedia +3](#)

Key Aspects of the Bath & Body Works Brand Story:

- **Founding & Growth:** Conceived as part of The Limited ecosystem, the brand leveraged strong retail, logistics, and merchandising capabilities to expand rapidly during the 1990s mall boom.
- **Rebranding & "Kate":** Following a 1991 lawsuit by The Body Shop, the brand reimagined its image, designing stores to feel like a "country home" and creating a fictional brand matriarch named "Kate" to anchor its wholesome, rustic aesthetic.
- **The "At Home" & White Barn Evolution:** The brand expanded into home fragrance, launching "Bath & Body Works at Home" in 1997 and later the White Barn Candle Company, a specialized division focused on scented candles.
- **Cultural Focus:** The brand relies on promoting "fragrance layering" and self-care routines, building on loyal, repeat customer transactions for staple products like *Warm Vanilla Sugar*.
- **Independence & Global Presence:** After decades under L Brands, Bath & Body Works became an independent, publicly traded company (NYSE: BBWI) in 2021 and now operates globally with a focus on, as CEO Daniel Heaf noted, bringing joy through fragrance. [Wikipedia +4](#)

Today, the brand emphasizes a "culture of belonging" and continues to innovate in both personal care and home fragrance categories. [www.bbwin.com](#)

Dive deeper in AI Mode



ChatGPT



Copilot



Bath & Body Works - Wikipedia

Bath & Body Works was founded in 1990 in New Albany, Ohio as the beauty line for Express, In...

[Wikipedia](#)



Exploring the Nostalgic History of Bath and Body Works in the ...

May 5, 2022 — i love it bath & Body...

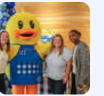
[TikTok · madihearts](#)



Bath & Body Works Turns 35—and the Celebration Smells ...

Sep 15, 2025 — "35 years ago, Bath & Body Works began with a simple idea: to bring joy...

[www.bbwin.com](#)

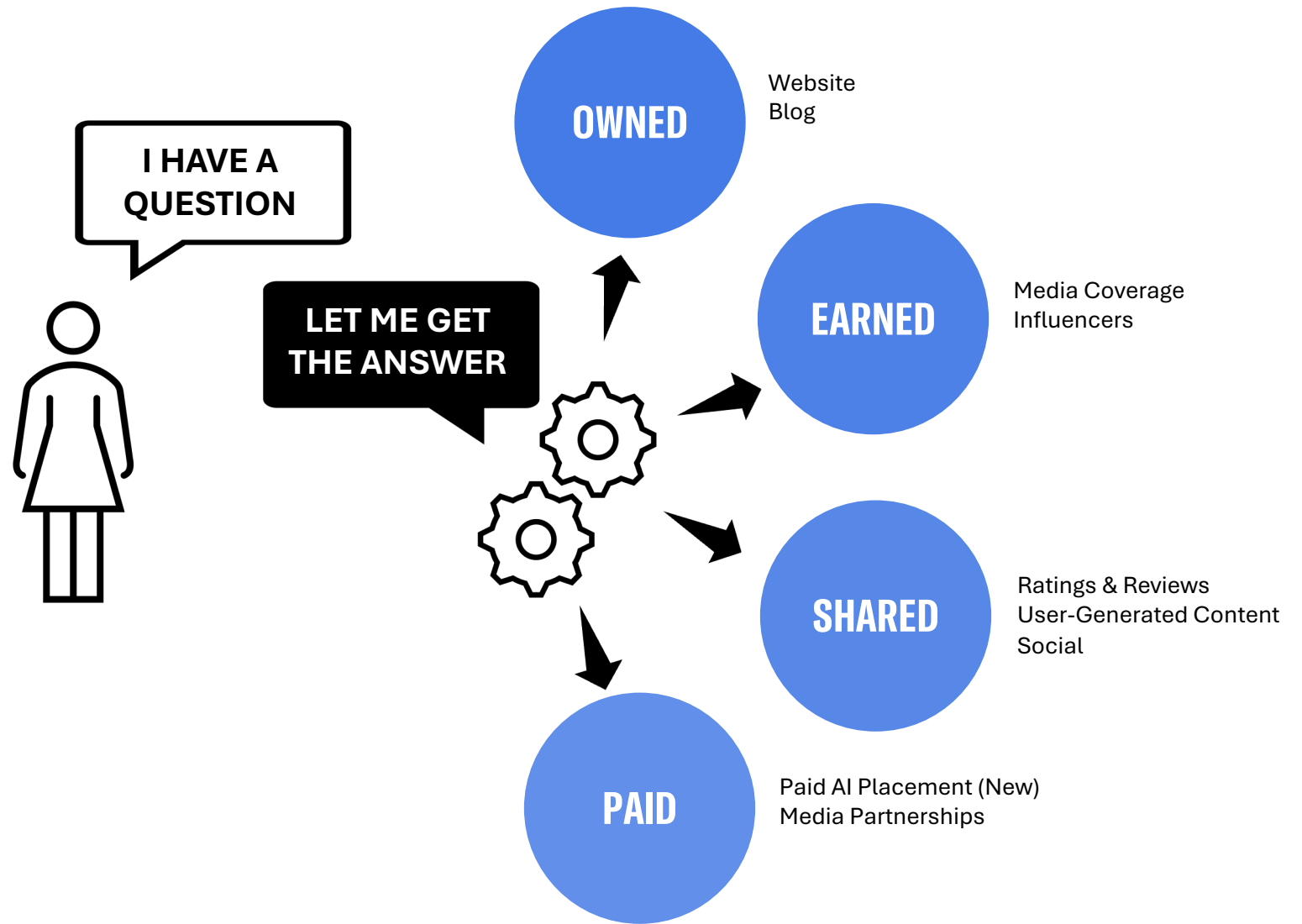


Show all

NEW PLAYBOOK FOR BRAND VISIBILITY

AI models do not see marketing silos.

They synthesize answers from the total digital footprint.





WHERE TO START: AI VISIBILITY STUDY

The Shipyard's AI Visibility Audit Covers:

- **Presence:** How and where your brand appears across high-intent audience questions
- **Narrative:** What AI says about your brand and the tone and accuracy of coverage
- **Source:** Which sources AI references — and whether/when your site is included
- **Competitive Context:** How your visibility compares to other sites

Comprehensive Audit

Reveals how your brand appears in AI-generated responses to customer questions

AI Models



ChatGPT

Gemini



perplexity



Copilot

Customized

(Not off-the-shelf generalizations)

Nuanced
Industry

Specific
Customers

Defined
Competitors



WHAT WE'VE DONE & WHERE WE STAND

1

ALIGNED ON AUDIT OBJECTIVES & SUBJECT MATTER

Identified the insights we were looking to find and designed how to frame the research. Included multiple rounds of prompt design to capture the right amount of data.

2

COLLECTED & ANALYZED THE AI SEARCH DATA

We leveraged research tools to field the customized audit study to capturing AI responses for deep analysis.

3

PREPARED A SUMMARY TO REVIEW TODAY

We've prepared this presentation along with a detailed analysis.



TODAY'S AGENDA: AI VISIBILITY AUDIT

01 **AUDIT OBJECTIVES & STRUCTURE**

02 **CITATION LANDSCAPE**

03 **NARRATIVE ANALYSIS**

04 **THEMES & OPPORTUNITIES**

05 **RECOMMENDATIONS**

07 **NEXT STEPS**



AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: OBJECTIVES & STRUCTURE

AUDIT OBJECTIVES

WHAT DID WE SET OUT TO LEARN?

- **How is BBW represented** in AI generated responses when journalists research the brand?
- Is BBW's **corporate website and newsroom** being surfaced as an authoritative source?
- How **accurate and consistent is the narrative** AI portrays about BBW?
- What **sources are shaping AI responses** most, and what is the balance across owned and other channels?
- What **opportunities exist** to improve BBW's visibility in AI search?

AUDIT STRUCTURE

HOW DID WE CONDUCT THE ANALYSIS?

- Analyzed AI visibility through a **journalist research lens** and phrased prompts the way a reporter might search for background, context, or validation
- Focused on topics relevant to the **audiences they serve**, covering **consumer-interest, business, trade, and investor themes**
- Framed product topics through a **corporate storytelling lens**, treating the corporate site and newsroom as a **reputational engine**
- Examined how AI platforms surfaced **narratives, citations, and source authority across broader landscape** — not just owned content

9 CATEGORIES | 66 PROMPTS | 5 DAYS | 5 AI MODELS (GOOGLE AI OVERVIEW, CHATGPT, GEMINI, MS COPILOT, PERPLEXITY)

Brand Identity & Positioning	Innovation & Product Dev	Business & Financial	Sustainability & Environment	Competitive/Market Context
Does bath and body works have a signature scent?	How does Bath & Body Works come up with its fragrances?	How are tariffs affecting Bath & Body Works's forecasts?	How are fragrance and body care brands addressing sustainability in packaging and ingredient sourcing?	What brands are shaping the future of fragrance and personal care?
How has Bath & Body Works evolved over the years?	How does Bath & Body Works talk about fragrance and scent?			What brands are shaping the future of fragrance, personal care, and home?
What emotional positioning does Bath & Body Works emphasize in its marketing?	What are Bath & Body Work's new product ideas?	How is Bath & Body Works performing as a business?	How are mass-market fragrance and body care brands addressing environmental impact?	What companies in the fragrance industry lead innovation?
What is Bath & Body Work's mission and values?	What Bath & Body Works products are being discussed online before retail launch?	How is consumer confidence affecting Bath & Body Works's forecasts?	Does Bath & Body Works follow responsible sourcing practices?	What companies lead in fragrance innovation?
What is Bath & Body works brand story?	What brand collaborations has Bath & Body Works had in the last 12 months?	How is inflation affecting Bath & Body Works's forecasts?	How is Bath & Body Works working to reduce its environmental impact through more sustainable products and packaging?	What trends are shaping the mass-market fragrance and body care industry?
What is Bath & Body Works known for?	What collabs have been a success at Bath & Body Works?	Is Bath & Body Works a good investment?		Which fragrance and body care brands are most associated with emotional or mood benefits?
What is Bath & Body Works?	What innovations is Bath & Body Works bringing to fragrance, home, and personal care?	What investment risks cited most often for Bath & Body Works?	Is Bath & Body Works doing anything to improve sustainable packaging?	Which fragrance and body care brands are successfully balancing business growth and sustainability?
What makes Bath & Body Works different from other home fragrance and personal care brands?		What is Bath & Body Works's growth strategy?	Is Bath & Body Works packaging recyclable?	
What's new with Bath & Body Works?	What major events or popular launches does Bath & Body Works hold each year?			Does Bath & Body Works have a good corporate reputation versus its competitors?
Customer Experience	Product Quality	Safety	Customer Reputation & ESG	How does Bath & Body Work's marketing distinguish itself versus its competitors?
Describe shopping at a Bath & Body Works store?	Do Bath & Body Works fragrances last as long as comparable products from other brands?	Are Bath & Body Works products safe?	Does Bath & Body Works support any social and community causes?	Who are Bath & Body Work's competitors?
Does Bath & Body Works have good customer service?		Are bath and body works products safe for kids?	Is Bath & Body Works a good employer?	
How popular is Bath & Body Works today and why do customers continue to shop there?	Do Bath & Body Works products do what they say they will?		Is Bath & Body Works a responsible company?	
What do people have to say about Bath & Body Works?	Does Bath & Body Works make good products?	Are bath and body works products safe for pets?	Is Bath & Body Works a woke company?	
What do people love about Bath & Body Works?	How well do Bath & Body Works hand creams and lotions actually hydrate and improve skin?	Does Bath & Body Works use 'toxic ingredients'?	What criticism has Bath & Body Works faced ?	
What's the Bath & Body Works shopping experience like?				
Who are Bath and Body Work's customer's				
Why do customers remain loyal to Bath & Body Works?				



AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: CITATION LANDSCAPE

HERE'S WHAT AI IS SAYING

CITATION LANDSCAPE

REPORT DATA EXPLAINED

Definitions & Reference

MENTIONS

WHAT IS A MENTION?

An AI response that references Bath & Body Works by name — whether or not a source URL is included. This includes variable name formats such as BBW, Bath and Body Works, etc.

MENTION RATE

The percentage of AI responses across all prompts tested that include at least one brand mention.

CITATIONS

WHAT IS A CITATION?

A specific source URL that an AI model includes in its response as a reference or supporting link when answering a prompt.

CITATION SOURCE CHANNELS



OWNED

Digital properties directly controlled by BBW, including corporate and consumer-facing websites.

PROPERTIES

www.bbwinc.com
careers.bbwinc.com
investors.bbwinc.com
bathandbodyworks.com



EARNED

External editorial, media, and press coverage that references Bath & Body Works without paid placement.

EXAMPLE DOMAINS

3blmedia.com
finance.yahoo.com
retaildive.com
forbes.com
csrwire.com



SHARED

User-generated content platforms and social communities where consumers organically discuss Bath & Body Works.

EXAMPLE DOMAINS

reddit.com
youtube.com
linkedin.com
facebook.com
instagram.com



3RD-PARTY

Broad but shallow array of sites that don't fit neatly into other categories. Accounts for the most unique domains, but the majority appear only once or twice.

EXAMPLE DOMAINS

matrixbcg.com
trustpilot.com
indeed.com
bbb.org
glassdoor.com

CITATION LANDSCAPE

TOP-LEVEL VIEW

Across the combined unaided and aided prompts, BBWINC.com is the top cited domain.



Owned	11%
Earned	22%
Shared	11%
3rd-Party	56%

Full Funnel

80% MENTION RATE

TOP 10 DOMAINS

- | | |
|----|--|
| 1 | • bbwinc.com |
| 2 | • reddit.com |
| 3 | • matrixbcg.com |
| 4 | • youtube.com |
| 5 | • en.wikipedia.org |
| 6 | • bathandbodyworks.com |
| 7 | • linkedin.com |
| 8 | • finance.yahoo.com |
| 9 | • investing.com |
| 10 | • portersfiveforce.com |

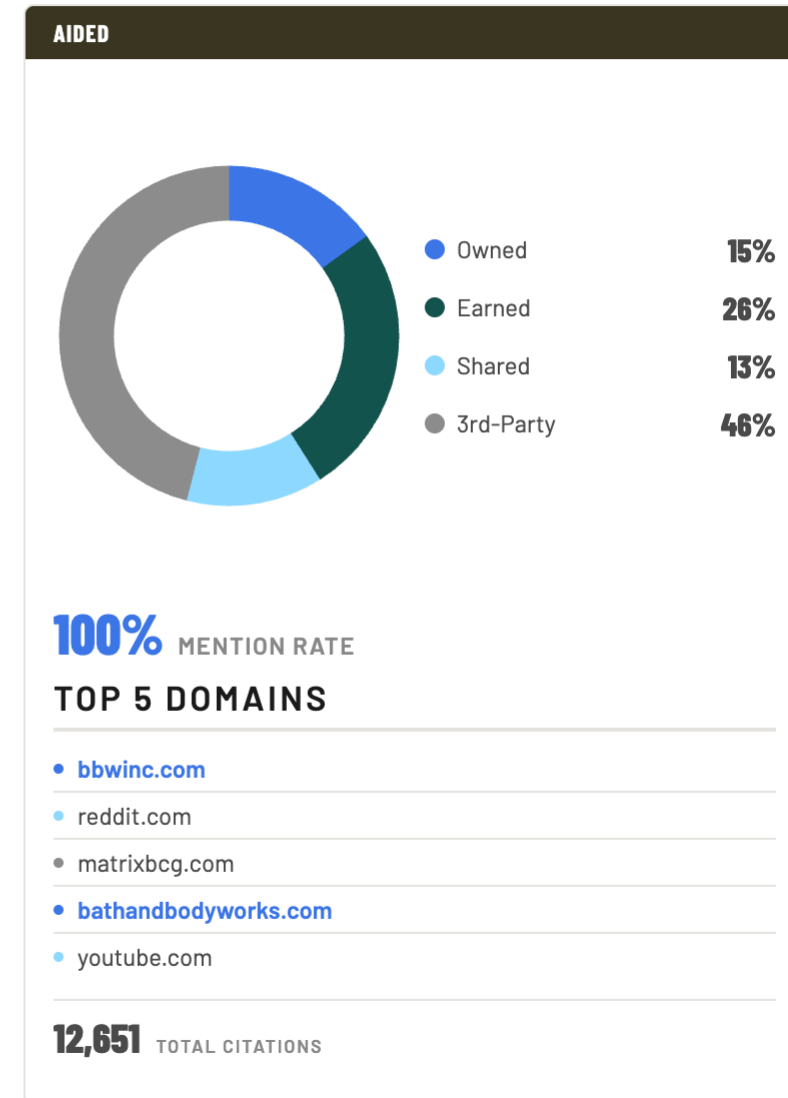
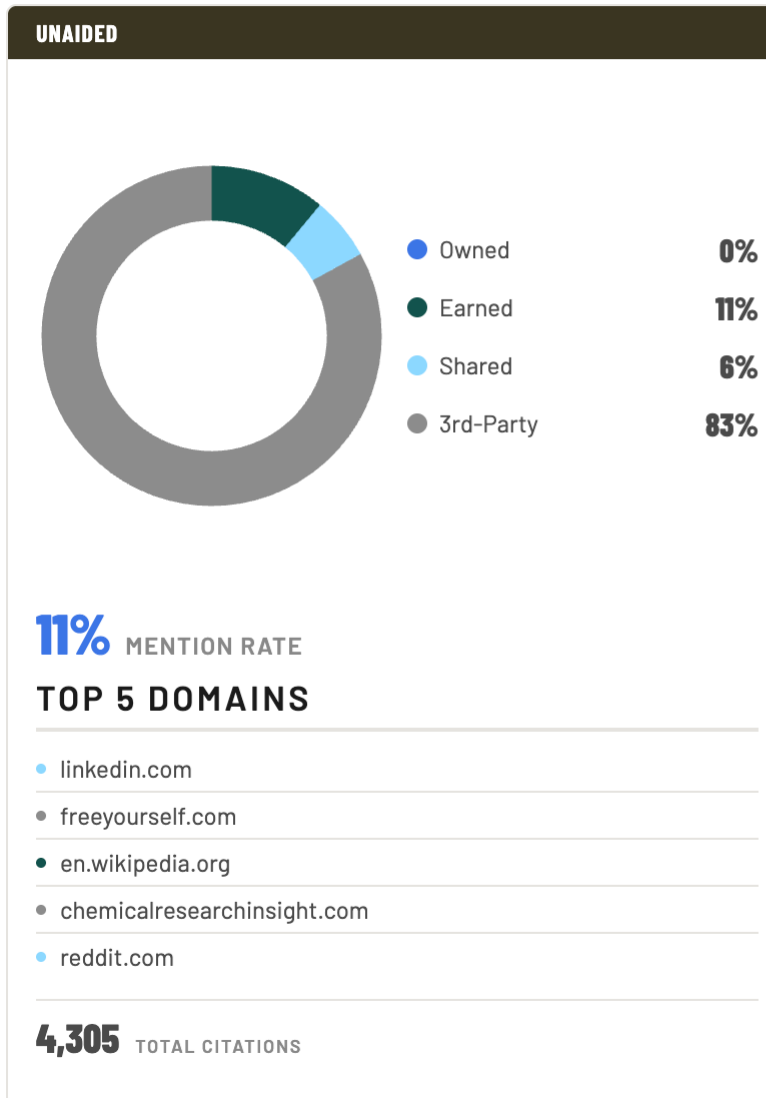
16,956 TOTAL CITATIONS · AIDED + UNAIDED

CITATION LANDSCAPE

VARIANCE BETWEEN UNAIDED & AIDED

Including the brand name in the prompt has a major affect on brand visibility in the AI responses.

Unaided vs. Aided

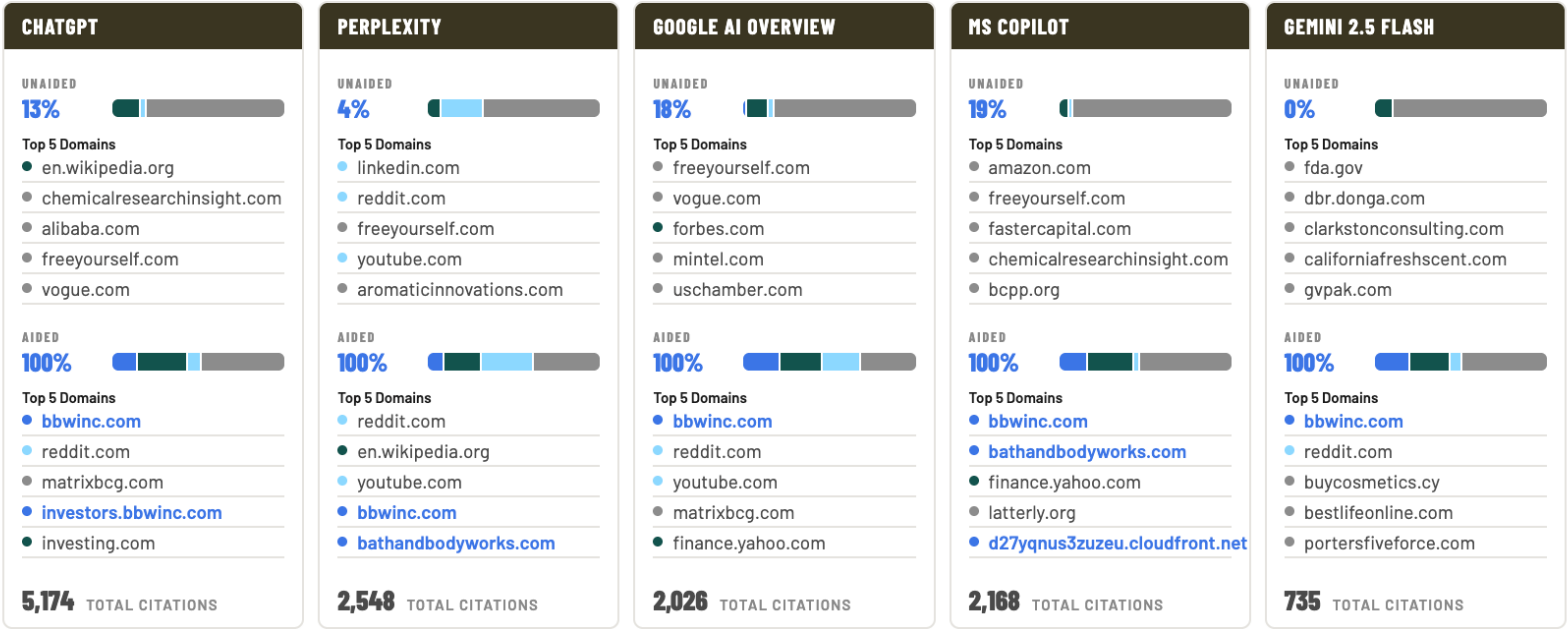


CITATION LANDSCAPE

VARIANCE BETWEEN AI MODELS

AI models do not all respond the same.

AI Models

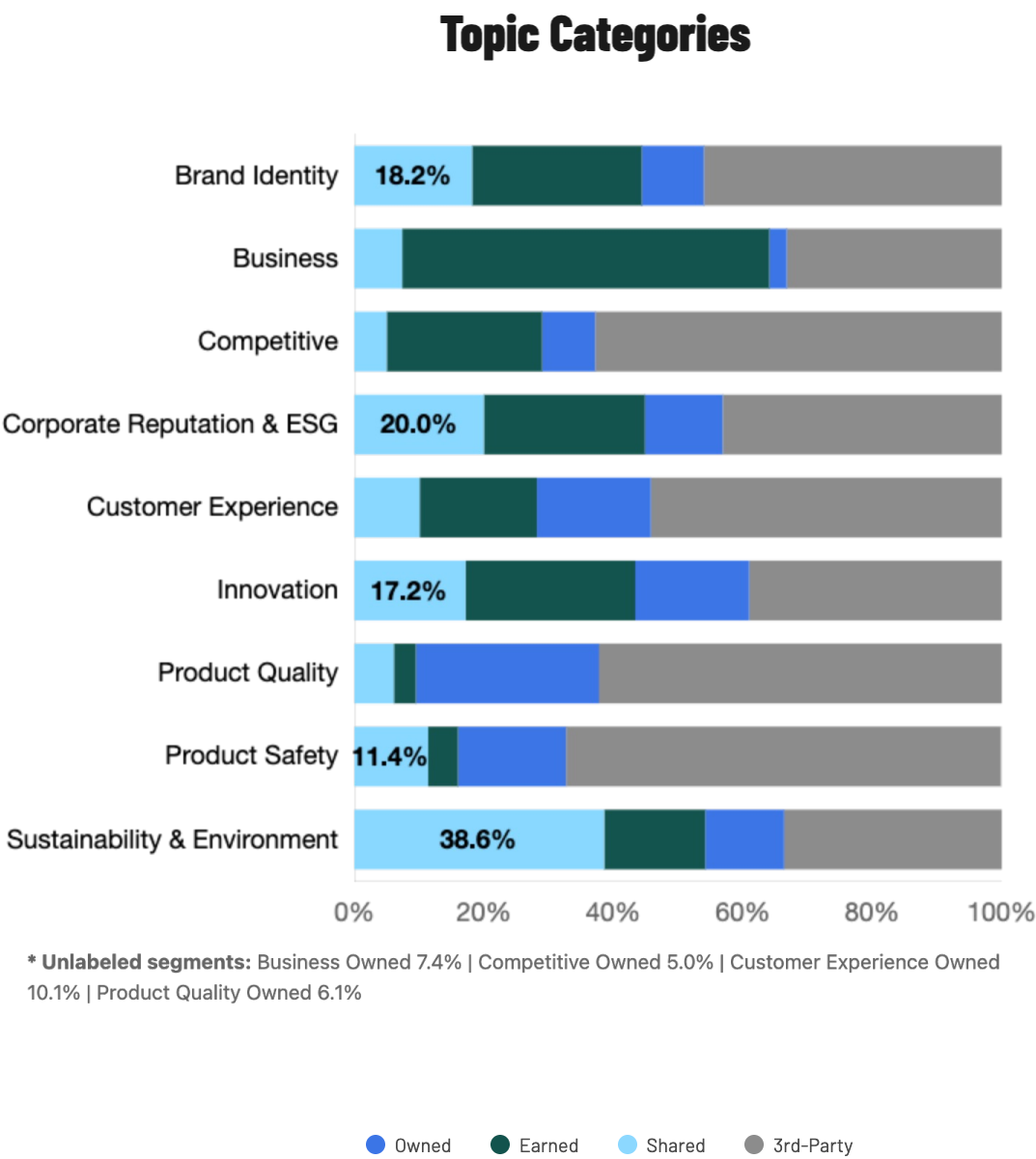


Owned Earned Shared 3rd-Party | % = Mention Rate

CITATION LANDSCAPE

VARIANCE ACROSS TOPIC CATEGORIES

Prompt topics also affect the channels that AI draws its information from.



CITATION LANDSCAPE

TOP DOMAINS BY TOPIC CATEGORIES

A more narrowed view shows where the BBW properties surface in the citations under the categories.

Topic Categories

BRAND IDENTITY & POSITIONING	BUSINESS & FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE	COMPETITIVE & MARKET CONTEXT
AIDED Top 5 Domains ● bbwinc.com ● en.wikipedia.org ● matrixbcg.com ● reddit.com ● careers.bathandbodyworks.com	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● investing.com ● finance.yahoo.com ● investors.bbwin.com ● seekingalpha.com ● nasdaq.com	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● matrixbcg.com ● portersfiveforce.com ● reddit.com ● bbwinc.com ● pestel-analysis.com
CORPORATE REPUTATION & ESG	CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE & SENTIMENT	INNOVATION & PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT
AIDED Top 5 Domains ● bbwinc.com ● reddit.com ● 3blmedia.com ● glassdoor.com ● indeed.com	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● reddit.com ● bbwinc.com ● trustpilot.com ● bathandbodyworks.com ● bbb.org	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● bbwinc.com ● reddit.com ● youtube.com ● bathandbodyworks.com ● bestlifeonline.com
PRODUCT QUALITY	SAFETY	SUSTAINABILITY & ENVIRONMENTAL
AIDED Top 5 Domains ● reddit.com ● bbwinc.com ● alibaba.com ● youtube.com ● trustpilot.com	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● bbwinc.com ● reddit.com ● thefiltery.com ● affinatiliving.com ● ewg.org	AIDED Top 5 Domains ● bbwinc.com ● reddit.com ● d27yqnus3zueu.cloudfront.net ● packagingdive.com ● brands.thecommons.earth

● Owned ● Earned ● Shared ● 3rd-Party

CITATION LANDSCAPE

OWNED: AT-A-GLANCE

Even with corporate-themed question prompts, AI pulls from all of the different properties and assets including the consumer site and PDFs.

Owned Website Source Mix



● BBWINC.com	70%
● Consumer	10%
● Investor	3%
● Careers	9%
● Corporate Report PDFs	8%

TOP 15 OWNED PAGES

1	● careers.bathandbodyworks.com/en/about-us
2	● bbwinc.com/about-us
3	● bathandbodyworks.com
4	● d27yqnus3zueu.cloudfront.net/bbw-staging/files/2023-esg-report...
5	● bbwinc.com/media/stories/how-bath-body-works-ensures-quality...
6	● bbwinc.com/product/product-quality-safety
7	● bbwinc.com/planet/packaging-plastics
8	● bbwinc.com
9	● bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/3bl-bbw-recognized-forbes-best-cx...
10	● investors.bbwinc.com/news-releases/bath-body-works-outlines-strategic...
11	● bbwinc.com/about-us/values
12	● bbwinc.com/planet
13	● bbwinc.com/media/stories/bath-body-works-turns-35...
14	● d27yqnus3zueu.cloudfront.net/bbw-staging/files/2024-sustainability...
15	● bbwinc.com/planet/sustainable-sourcing

CITATION LANDSCAPE

OWNED:
BBWINC.COM –
A TOP AUTHORITATIVE
SOURCE

The corporate site performs very well
as a cited source.

All Channels

9%

Of total Aided citations
across all channels

Owned Citations

63%

Of total Owned
citations

Aided Prompts

100%

The next closest is
Reddit with 64%

Of Aided prompts
included a citation

Newsroom & Stories

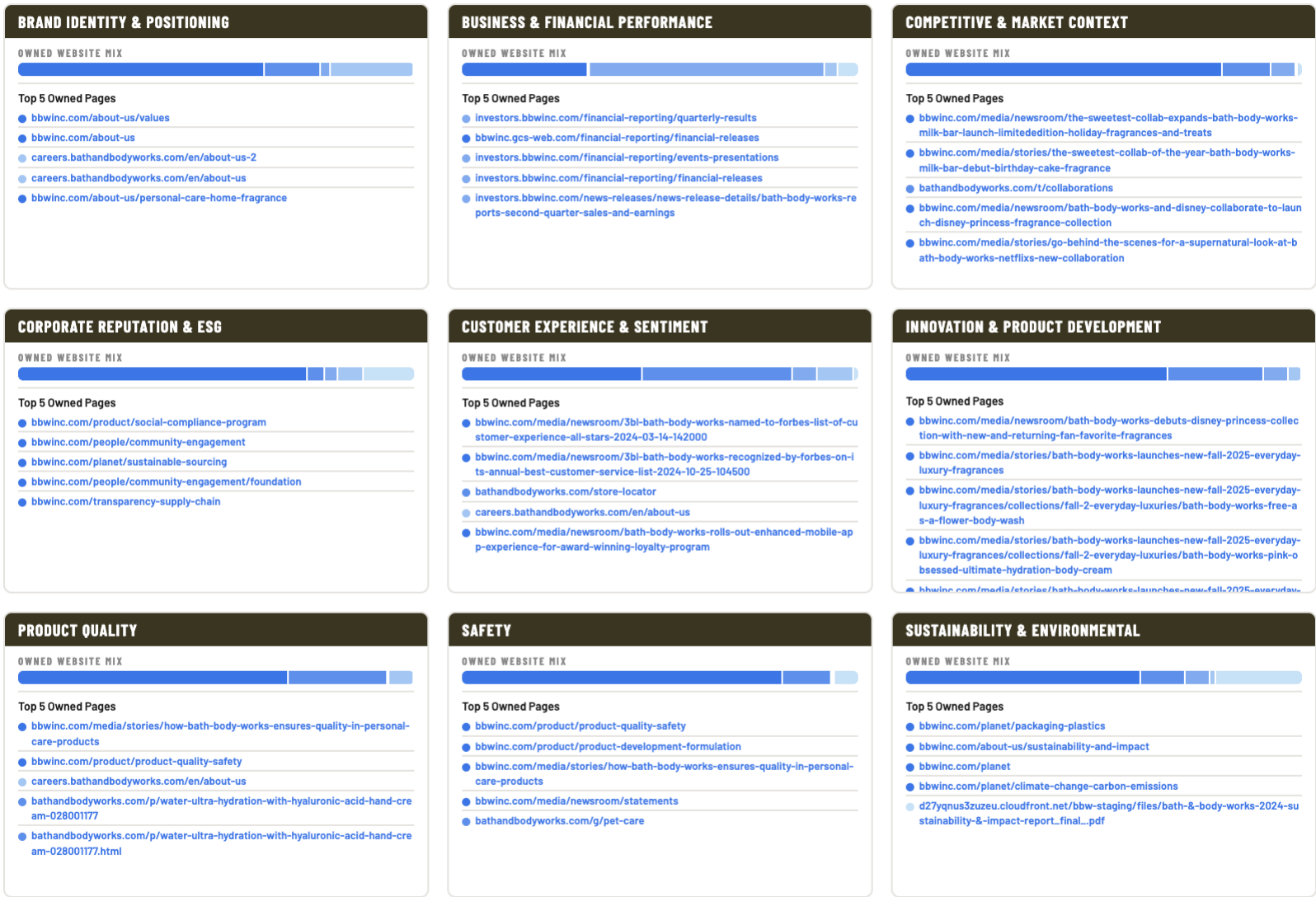
TOP 15 MEDIA PAGES

1	bbwinc.com/media/stories/how-bath-body-works-ensures-quality-in-personal-care-products	STORY
2	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/3bl-bath-body-works-recognized-by-forbes-on-its-annual-best-customer-service-list-2024-10-25-104500	NEWSROOM
3	bbwinc.com/media/stories/bath-body-works-turns-35-and-the-celebration-smells-amazing	STORY
4	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/n-bath-body-works-outlines-strategic-transformation-for-sustainable-growth-and-reports-2025-third-quarter-results-2025-11-20-065533	NEWSROOM
5	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/3bl-bath-body-works-named-to-forbes-list-of-customer-experience-all-stars-2024-03-14-142000	NEWSROOM
6	bbwinc.com/media/stories/bath-body-works-most-loved-fragrances-of-2025	STORY
7	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/bath-body-works-officially-launches-in-amazons-us-stores-expanding-access-to-its-iconic-fragrances-and-most-loved-products	NEWSROOM
8	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/n-bath-body-works-reports-2024-fourth-quarter-and-full-year-results-and-provides-2025-guidance-2025-02-27-062507	NEWSROOM
9	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/n-bath-body-works-announces-the-return-of-annual-candle-day-2025-12-02-090041	NEWSROOM
10	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/n-bath-body-works-releases-inaugural-esg-report-2023-04-05-090610	NEWSROOM
11	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/bath-body-works-debuts-disney-princess-collection-with-new-and-returning-fan-favorite-fragrances	NEWSROOM
12	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/the-sweetest-collab-expands-bath-body-works-milk-bar-launch-limited-edition-holiday-fragrances-and-treats	NEWSROOM
13	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/beyond-the-screen-bath-body-works-shines-a-spotlight-on-the-power-of-scent	NEWSROOM
14	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/n-bath-body-works-launches-in-over-600-college-campus-es-nationwide-2025-08-06-090043	NEWSROOM
15	bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/3bl-bath-body-works-named-one-of-americas-most-trustworthy-companies-by-newsweek-2023-04-11-110000	NEWSROOM

CITATION LANDSCAPE

OWNED: TOP CITED PAGES BY CATEGORY

Owned Citations across Topic Categories

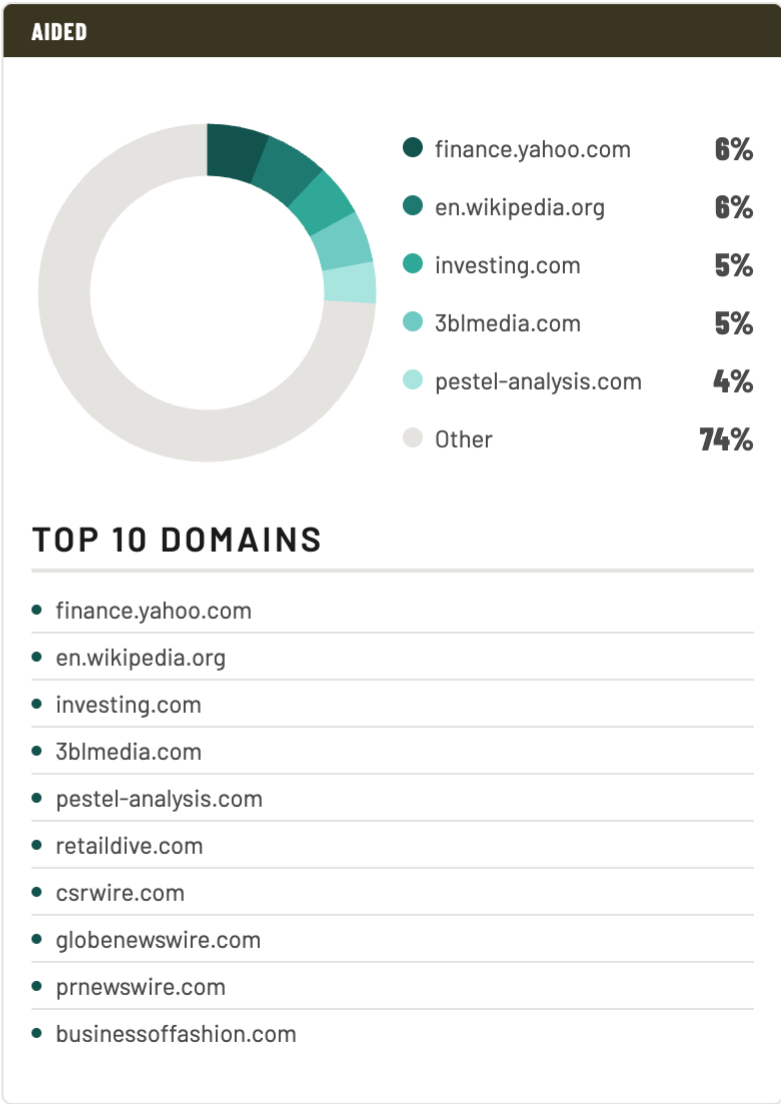
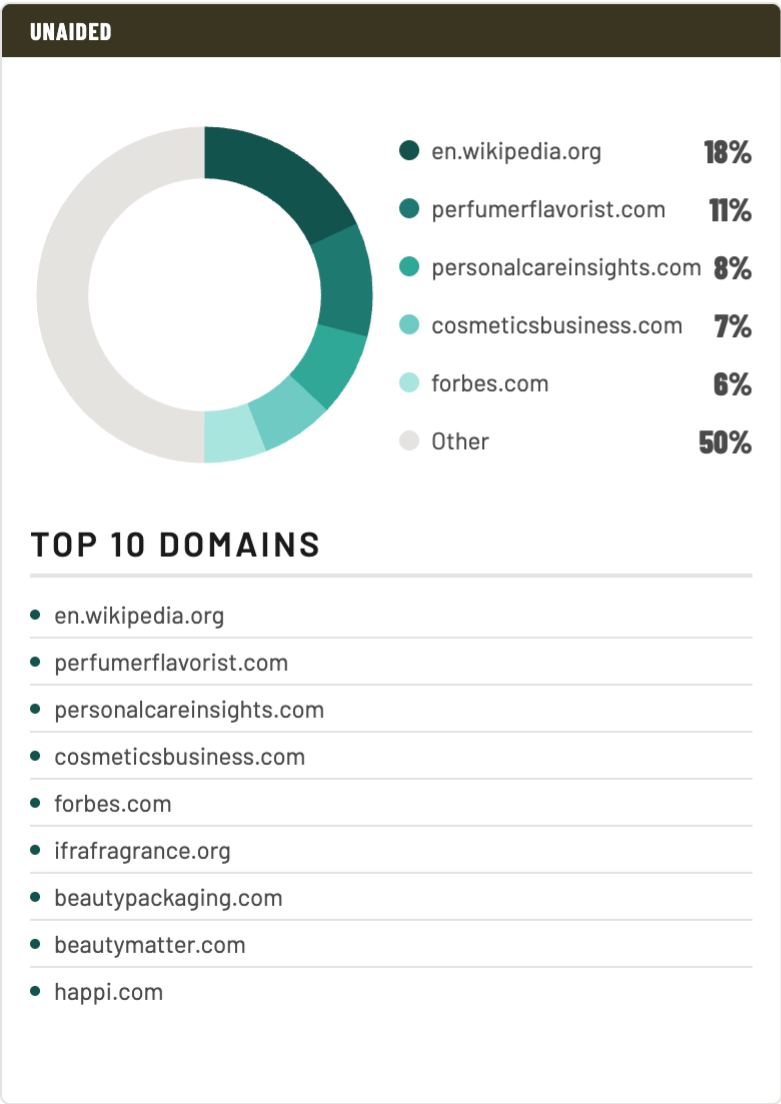


CITATION LANDSCAPE

EARNED: AT-A-GLANCE

Newsires appear prominently in responses to questions when the brand name is included (aided).

Earned Channel

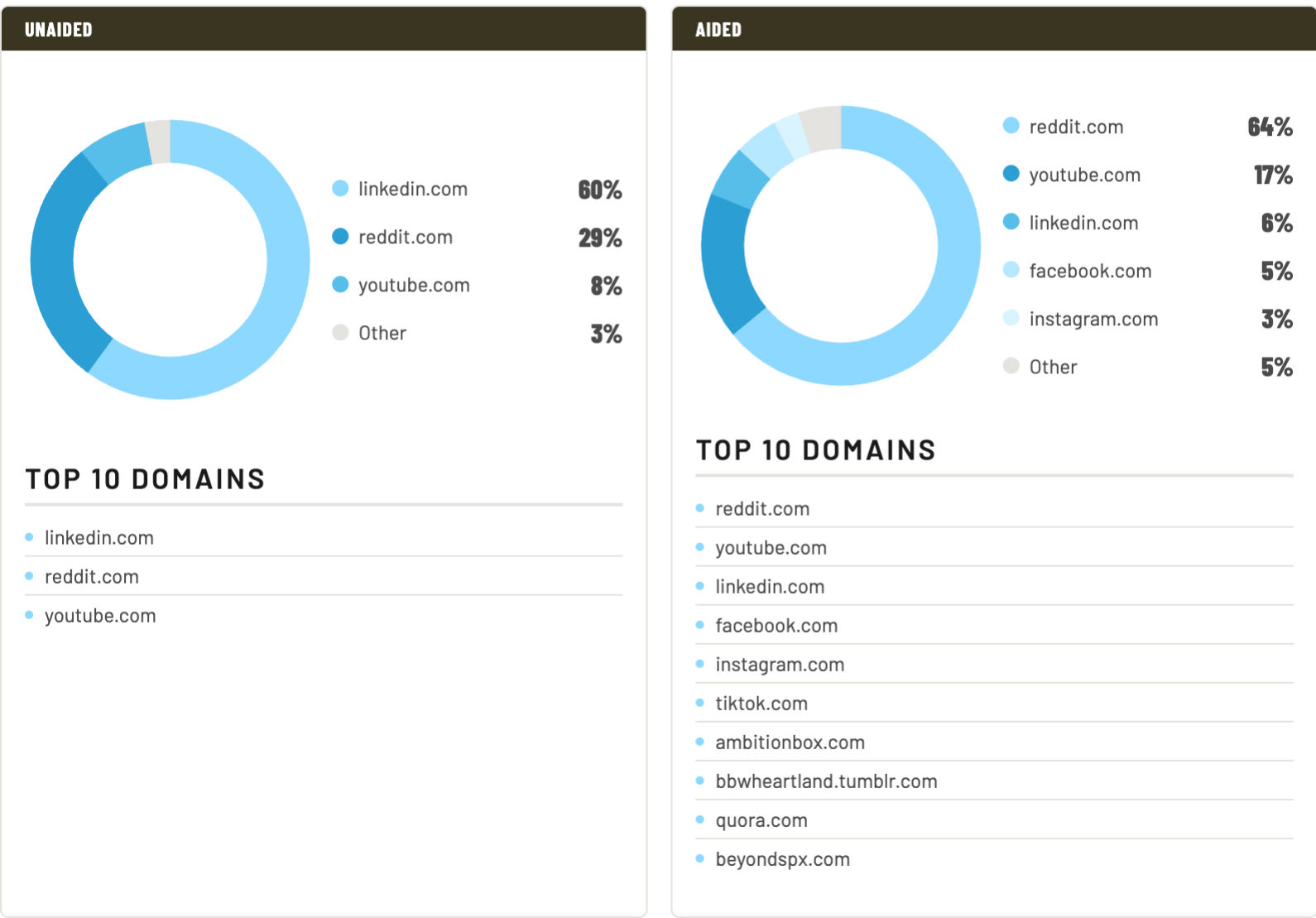


CITATION LANDSCAPE

SHARED: AT-A-GLANCE

Reddit is at or near top of the list.

Shared Channel

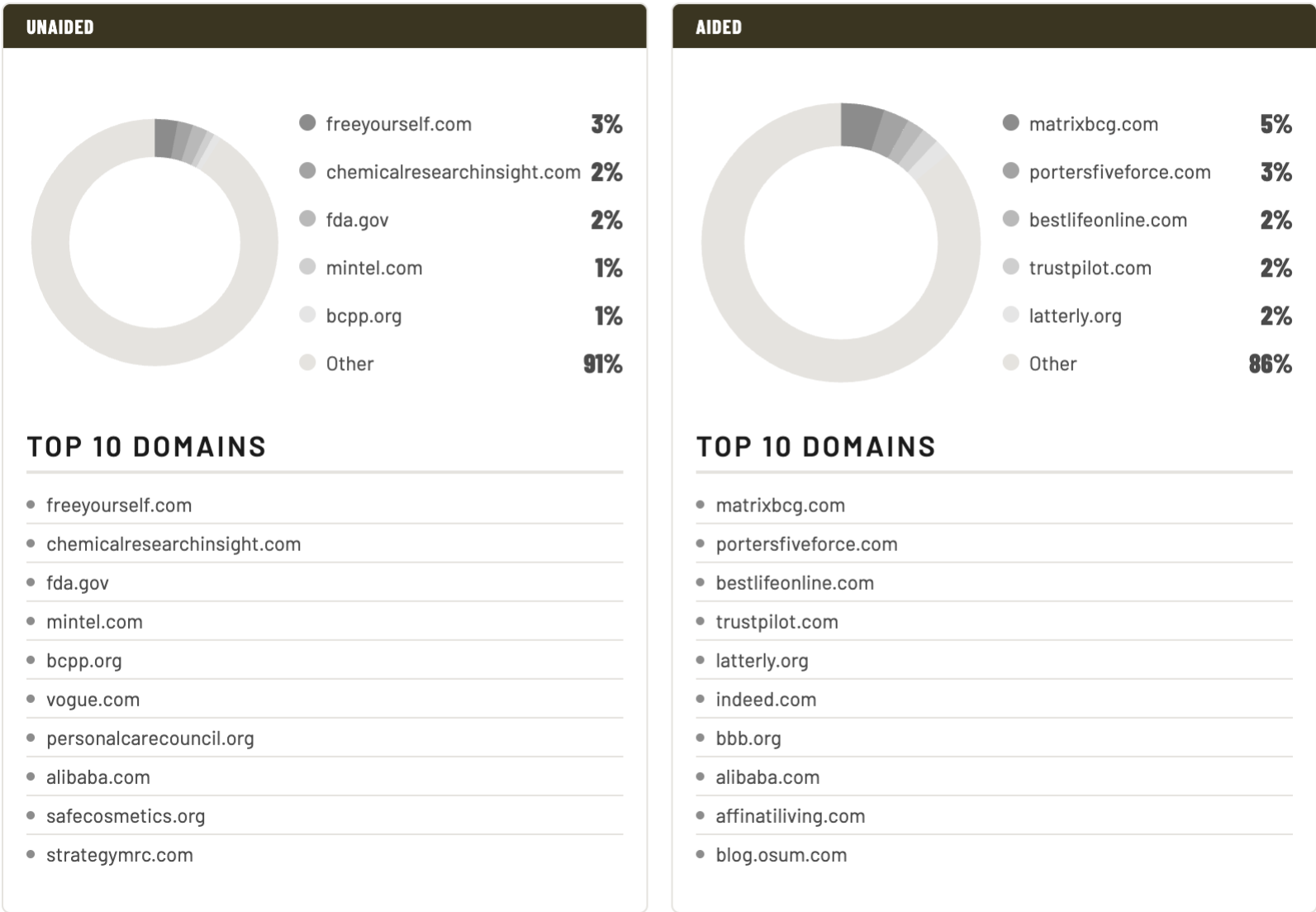


CITATION LANDSCAPE

3rd-PARTY: AT-A-GLANCE

This is comprised of domains that don't fit neatly into the other categories and that as a brand may not have much influence over.

3rd-Party Channel





AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: NARRATIVE ANALYSIS



NARRATIVE ANALYSIS FRAMEWORK

HOW WE RATED BATH & BODY WORK'S CONTROL OF THE STORY BEING TOLD

1

STRONG CONTROL

- AI responses align with BBW corporate messaging
- Owned sources (newsroom, stories, etc.) are present or an authority throughout
- Consistent messaging throughout models & data set

2

MIXED SIGNALS

- Competing narratives throughout responses
- Less authority in owned category
- Models or data set may differ over days

3

INCONGRUENT

- AI contradicts BBW corporate site consistently
- Third party sites control citations
- Models and data set have a consistent negative or contradictory sentiment

BBW CONTROLS NARRATIVE



EMOTIONAL & NOSTALGIC POSITIONING

The most consistent and positive messaging across all engines. BBW has clear and consistent positioning that is the anchor to who they are and the story they tell.

Red highlight = Negative messaging

Green highlight = Positive messaging

Yellow highlight = Key callout

What emotional positioning does Bath & Body Works emphasize in its marketing?

"Bath & Body Works consistently frames its products as **small, joyful luxuries** that elevate everyday life. Their campaigns highlight how **scent** can instantly shift your mood, offering **comfort, calm, or excitement.**"

Microsoft Copilot

"Bath & Body Works emphasizes an emotional positioning of **accessible luxury, self-care, and sensory escapism**, aiming to make daily life **"brighter and happier"** through fragrance. Marketing campaigns like "[Come Back to Your Senses]"

Google AI Overview

"Accessible Self-Care & Well-Being

Bath & Body Works positions its products not as luxuries for the elite, but as **essential emotional tools** for everyday mental health. The "Daily Ritual": Marketing focuses on **turning mundane tasks** (washing hands, showering) into small **"moments of zen."**

Gemini-2.5-Flash

Bath and Body Works Shines a Spotlight on the Power of Scent

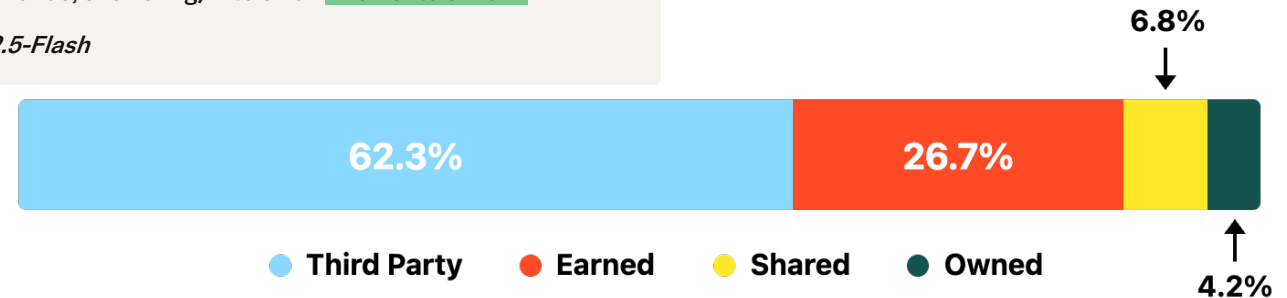
"Inspired by the season's fleeting moments the assortment introduces both beloved classics and new trend-driven fragrances. Designed to **awaken the senses and brighten everyday rituals**, these products capture the **joy, optimism, and transformation** that defines spring.

<https://www.bbwinc.com/media/stories/bath-body-works-welcomes-spring-with-blooming-florals-new-musk-and-coastalinspired-home>

Bath and Body Works Shines a Spotlight on the Power of Scent

"Through continued expansion of the brand's "Come Back To Your Senses" creative platform, the campaign illustrates the power fragrance has in **connecting consumers to their emotions, memories and moods**. After all, the sense of **smell** can be a **powerful**, yet often underappreciated, tool for **enriching daily life**.

<https://www.bbwinc.com/media/newsroom/beyond-the-screen-bath-body-works-shines-a-spotlight-on-the-power-of-scent>



95.8%

Of citations related to emotional positioning come from external sources and they all agree on one thing: BBW owns nostalgic and emotional positioning.

BBW CONTROLS NARRATIVE



INNOVATION & PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

BBW's innovation story is captured line by line when prompted. Content is working and can be *extremely authoritative*

Red highlight = Negative messaging

Green highlight = Positive messaging

Yellow highlight = Key callout

What innovations is Bath & Body Works bringing to fragrance and personal care?

"The brand has launched Everyday Luxuries, a line of more elevated, perfume-inspired fragrances designed to deliver premium scent experiences at accessible prices — now expanded across more formats like sprays, body wash, creams, and candles. [Bath & Body Works, Inc.]"

Chat-GPT

What is Bath & Body Work's growth strategy?

"Bath & Body Works has formally outlined a transformation plan called the Consumer First Formula, which guides its growth initiatives. This strategy focuses on four key priorities:

1. Creating disruptive and innovative products tailored to core categories like body care, home fragrance, soaps, and sanitizers.

2. Reigniting the brand through stronger storytelling and cultural relevance.

3. Winning in the marketplace by enhancing digital and in-store experiences and expanding into new channels.

4. Operating with speed and efficiency to reinvest savings into revenue-driving initiatives.
[GlobeNewswire](https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2025/11/20/3191743/0/en/Bath-Body-Works-Outlines-Strategic-Transformation-for-Sustainable-Growth-and-Reports-2025-Third-Quarter-Results.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com)"

Chat-GPT

Bath & Body Works Launches New Fall 2025 Everyday Luxury Fragrances

"The Bath & Body Works Everyday Luxuries collection offers sophisticated, high-end-inspired fragrances designed to feel indulgent without the luxury price tag."

<https://www.bbwincc.com/media/stories/bath-body-works-launches-new-fall-2025-everyday-luxury-fragrances?>

Global Newswire Q3 2025 Report

"We will focus on reestablishing product leadership by creating innovative offerings focused on our core categories of body care, home fragrance, soaps, and sanitizers."

"We will build enduring fragrance franchises around iconic scents, paired with elevated visual storytelling and social momentum across all consumer touchpoints."

"We will continue to enhance our digital and in-store experiences, while expanding into new wholesale channels and marketplaces."

"We have plans to deliver \$250 million in cost savings over two years, with over half identified for 2026. These savings will be used to invest in revenue generating initiatives across product and brand."

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2025/11/20/3191743/0/en/Bath-Body-Works-Outlines-Strategic-Transformation-for-Sustainable-Growth-and-Reports-2025-Third-Quarter-Results.html?>

BBW NARRATIVE

SUSTAINABILITY

The Sustainability story exists and shows immense progress in the public eye. However, it's outdated and buried deep within the site.

4TH RANKED OWNED CITE

Sustainability report is the 4th ranked owned source behind only pillar pages.

Red highlight = Negative messaging

Green highlight = Positive messaging

Yellow highlight = Key callout

Is Bath & Body Works doing anything to improve sustainable packaging?

"PCR Plastic & Reduced Packaging: By 2025, the company aims to have 50% of its packaging made from sustainable materials and has shifted towards 100% PCR plastic for items like hand soap bottles.

Design for Recycling: They have introduced "wash-away" label adhesives to help remove labels at recycling centers, making plastic packaging more recyclable.

Refills & Waste Reduction: The company is expanding its refillable product options and has reduced excessive packaging for online gift sets and accessories.

Sustainable Materials: [Bath & Body Works](https://www.bbwin.com/planet/sustainable-sourcing)"

"Bath & Body Works has responsible sourcing practices in place: it uses supplier codes of conduct, ethical training, sustainability commitments, and engagement with certification groups like RSPO — and it publicly reports on progress toward these goals. However, like many large consumer brands, it is still evolving its programmes and measuring full supply chain sustainability over time."

Chat-GPT

Is Bath & Body Works doing anything to improve sustainable packaging?

"Integrated perforation to shrink labels* on our 100% PCR hand soap bottles, making labels easier to remove before disposal."

"Validated the use of "wash-away" label adhesives that allow labels to more easily be separated from our product packaging at plastics reclamation facilities."

"Our wallflower bulbs fill rooms with always-on fragrance. Consisting of a decorative plug-in and a refillable fragrance bulb, they are a customer favorite"

Sustainability Impact Report 2024

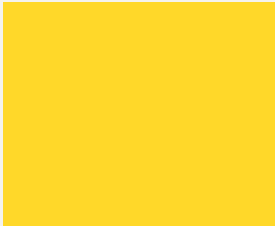
"The Bath & Body Works supplier compliance guidebook contains our Supplier Code of Conduct and compliance standards related to forced labor and human trafficking"

"Updated our Global Ingredients and Global Documentation policies for suppliers to align with our RSPO commitment."

Sustainability Impact Report 2024

URL	Citation Count
https://d27yqnus3zuzeu.cloudfront.net/bbw-staging/files/2023-esg-report_final_5.16.24.pdf	45
https://www.bbwin.com/planet/sustainable-sourcing	25
https://bbwin.com/about-us/sustainability-and-impact/sustainability-and-impact-reports	11

BBW NARRATIVE



RESPONSIBILITY AND ESG

BBW has earned their trust and loyalty with customers. Criticism has to be sought out in order to find it.

- Red highlight = Negative messaging
- Green highlight = Positive messaging
- Yellow highlight = Key callout

Is Bath & Body Works a responsible company?

"Bath & Body Works partners with charities like Good360 to donate unsold products to shelters, food banks, and disaster relief programs, helping reduce waste and support communities."

Search-GPT

What criticism has Bath & Body Works faced?

"Performative" Marketing: In 2022, the brand was accused of cultural appropriation for its Black History Month collection, which featured "Kente-cloth-inspired" packaging on standard scents rather than creating new products that authentically honored the community.

Gemini-2.5-flash

"Yes, Bath & Body Works has a strong corporate reputation in the U.S., frequently recognized for being trustworthy, responsible, and a top employer. It ranks as a leader in consumer goods, outperforming competitors in customer loyalty (38 million+ loyalty members) and in-store experience, with a 38 Net Promoter Score."

Google AI Overview

Does Bath & Body Works Support any social causes

Channel	% of Prompt
Owned	41.3%
Earned	11.5%
Shared	6.3%
Third Party	40.9%

Is Bath & Body Works a good employer

Channel	% of Prompt
Owned	8.8%
Earned	4.0%
Shared	10.8%
Third Party	76.3%

"Since early 2023, we have worked with Good360 to find donation outlets across our markets for marked-out-of-stock products (products unable to be sold to customers)"

2024 Sustainability & Impact Report

"We are guided by our purpose and values, high ethical standards and deep-rooted passion for fragrance. This approach has earned trust and loyalty with our customers and allowed us to offer the unique Bath & Body Works experience they love for more than 30 years."

2024 Sustainability & Impact Report

BBW NARRATIVE



PRODUCT SAFETY

The question is not FDA regulation or government compliance, but whether BBW products will keep their home safe.

There is no proactive owned content reframing fears, only stated the ingredient and regulatory fact.

Red highlight = Negative messaging

Green highlight = Positive messaging

Yellow highlight = Key callout

Are Bath & Body Works products safe for pets?

"Respiratory Sensitivity: Pets have a much more acute sense of smell and smaller lungs. Paraffin wax (found in many BBW candles) releases soot and volatile organic compounds (VOCs) like benzene and toluene, **which can cause respiratory distress, coughing, or sneezing.**

Essential Oil Toxicity: Many products contain essential oils like eucalyptus, peppermint, citrus, and tea tree. **These can be toxic to dogs and cats** if inhaled in high concentrations or ingested (e.g., if a Wallflower leaks or a pet licks lotion off your skin).

Gemini-2.5-flash

"Even though regulatory limits are met, some ingredients in Bath & Body Works products raise concern among scientists, safety advocates, and consumer groups:

1) Fragrance (synthetic blends): **"Some fragrance components can include VOCs or allergens linked to respiratory irritation or endocrine disruption.** [The Environmental Blog+1]

2) Paraffin wax (in candles): Paraffin is petroleum-derived and when burned can emit compounds like benzene and toluene, which have been associated with **respiratory irritation and possible carcinogenic effects** at high levels.

3) Preservatives: Some products may have formaldehyde-releasing preservatives or isothiazolinones (like methylisothiazolinone), which can trigger skin allergies in sensitive people. [Bath & Body Works, Inc.+1]

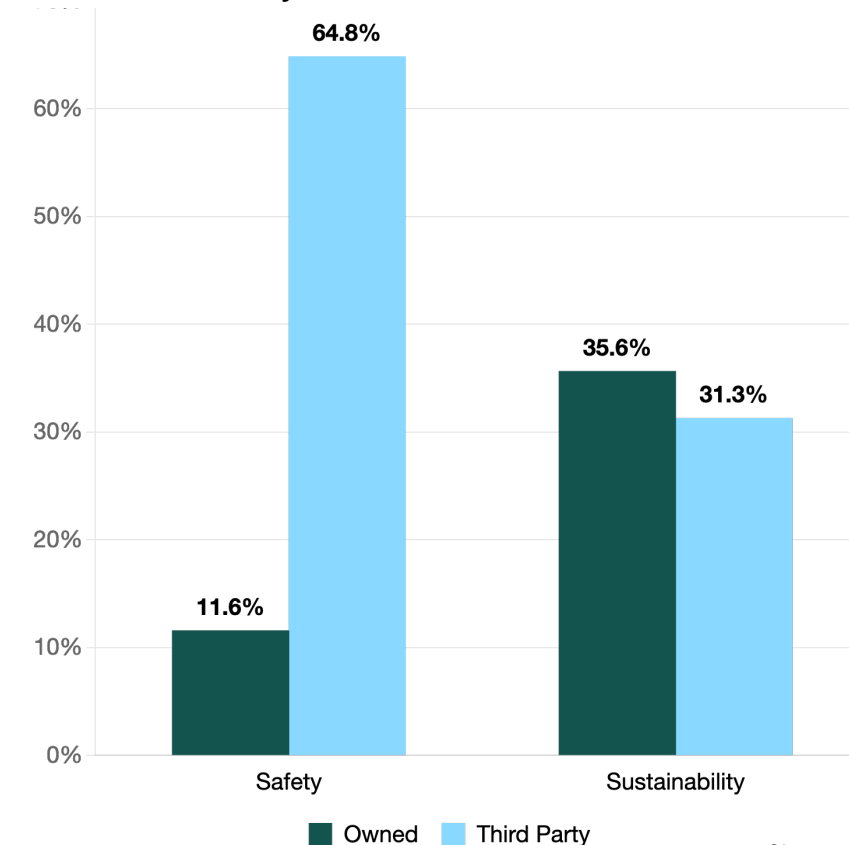
Chat-GPT

Bath & Body Works Product Formulation

"Isothiazolinones are a family of preservatives commonly used in consumer products. Methylisothiazolinone (MI) or combination of methylchloroisothiazolinone and methylisothiazolinone (MCI/MI) are two forms commonly used in rinse-off products, such as shower gel and hand soaps to prevent bacterial growth.

<https://www.bbwincc.com/product/product-development-formulation>

Safety vs Sustainability Citation Rate For Owned and Third-Party Channel



THIRD PARTY REVIEW CITES OWN NARRATIVE



DIGITAL CONSUMER EXPERIENCE

With such a strong image serving customers in person, the BBW brand hits a speed bump with it's online user experience.

- Red highlight** = Negative messaging
- Green highlight** = Positive messaging
- Yellow highlight** = Key callout

Does Bath & Body Works have good customer service?

"Generally considered inconsistent, with numerous reports of poor experiences particularly regarding online orders. While in-store staff can be helpful, customers frequently report issues with, such as long hold times, cancelled orders, and ineffective support via chat."

Google AI Overview

"Bath & Body Works does not have a strong reputation for customer service based on the most recent publicly available reviews."

Microsoft Copilot

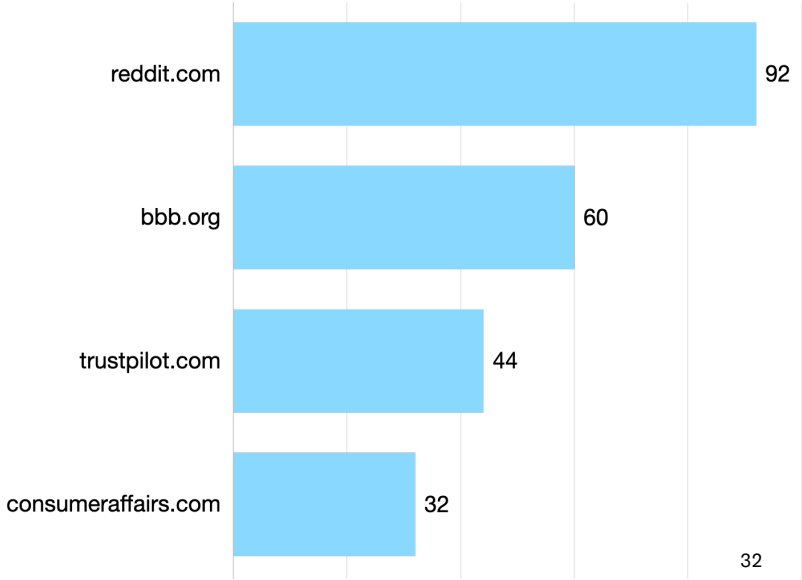
Source General Tone Key Takeaways		
Trustpilot-style customer reviews	Mostly negative	Complaints about missing items, delayed deliveries, and order issues. Trustpilot
Reddit fragrance community	Mixed	Some enjoy the scents; others feel they smell "juvenile" or nostalgic. Reddit
ConsumerAffairs	Mostly negative	Wide scent variety and sales praised, but inconsistent quality and customer service issues noted. ConsumerAffairs
Birdeye (store-specific reviews)	Very positive	High ratings for in-store experience, helpful staff, and product selection. Birdeye
Bath & Body Works site reviews	Mixed	Only about a quarter of reviewers recommend the brand; delivery and service issues common. REVIEWS.io
Microsoft Copilot		

"Our dedication to customers and the experience they have with our brand drives us forward. We work tirelessly to develop moments of truth and service that set us apart and deepen longstanding relationships with all who choose our amazing products."

[Bath Body Works Rolls Out Enhanced Mobile App Experience](#)

"Our customers are at the center of everything we do. We're committed to providing a seamless experience and deepening our connection every time they engage with our brand"

Top Domains For Prompts in the Customer Experience Category





AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: THEMES + OPPORTUNITIES



THEMES

MIGRATING FINDINGS TO FOCUS: DISTILLING THE CITATION LANDSCAPE INTO OMNIPRESENT THEMES.

1

BBWINC.COM OWNS TRUST

Trust in the AI era is measured in citations. Bath & Body Works has earned that trust — and built it in exactly the right place.

2

COMMUNITIES OWN FEELINGS

When queries shift from fact to feeling, AI shifts its sourcing — to community platforms, forums, and consumer review sites.

3

DIFFERENT AI, DIFFERENT AGENDA

Copilot, Perplexity, ChatGPT, and Gemini draw from different source hierarchies. The brand is being represented differently depending on where a consumer asks.

4

AI SYNTHESIZES SYNTHESIS

Pre-connected narratives reduce the risk of AI assembling its own version from raw, disconnected sources. The brand that narrates itself is harder to misrepresent.

5

ARCHITECTURE IS AUTHORITY

Schema markup and structured data are the signals AI reads before it reads copy. Building for machine-readability is a primary channel for brand representation.



OPPORTUNITIES: AUTHORITY

BBW corporate domain authority is well-established. The opportunity is in connecting owned properties so AI consolidates that authority rather than distributing it.

When a source is difficult to find directly, citation authority migrates to whoever summarizes it.

Third-party financial aggregators are performing strongly alongside investors.bbwin.com for business performance queries, capturing citation authority that the owned investor subdomain is positioned to reclaim.

The corporate domain and investor subdomain currently operate without the cross-linking that would signal a unified, authoritative source of record to AI platforms evaluating the full corporate ecosystem.

Current wire distribution practices are inadvertently co-locating predatory law firm alerts with brand content, a structural issue that surfaces directly in AI-generated results around the brand.



OPPORTUNITIES: SENTIMENT

BBW's corporate domain authority is well-established. The opportunity is in connecting owned properties so AI consolidates that authority rather than distributing it.

AI platforms are inclined to use sentiment and opinion-based sites for queries that mirror that intent. Finding ways to augment that inclination is important.

For subjective queries, Reddit is within striking distance of bbwinc.com as a primary AI reference and no owned counter-narrative is currently positioned to compete for that ground.

Perplexity's sourcing currently favors community platforms over the corporate domain for consumer-facing topics, meaning brand sentiment on that platform is largely shaped by third-party voices.

No owned content directly addresses the qualitative questions AI is most frequently being asked about the brand, leaving those queries to be answered by whatever authoritative-seeming source is available.

No content structure exists to absorb and redirect high-frequency, high-volatility queries, the questions most likely to generate negative sentiment have no owned landing point.



OPPORTUNITIES: NARRATIVE

BBW's corporate domain authority is well-established. The opportunity is in connecting owned properties so AI consolidates that authority rather than distributing it.

Closing the depth gap using the ingredients site

Bath & Body Works has meaningful ESG and sustainability authority, but AI is actively surfacing legacy goals and outdated data ahead of current validated progress, the brand's present position is not the story being told.

Ingredient and product pages are factually accurate but answer "what" without addressing "why", a depth gap that consistently sends AI looking elsewhere for context, formulation rationale, and brand purpose.

In-store experience registers as a genuine and consistent brand strength across consumer sentiment, but digital pain points like pricing clarity and returns currently carry disproportionate weight in the narrative AI constructs and surfaces.



OPPORTUNITIES: TECHNICAL

BBW's corporate domain authority is well-established. The opportunity is in connecting owned properties so AI consolidates that authority rather than distributing it.

Structured data and schema markup across pillar pages and the newsroom are not yet developed to the level that actively guides AI in identifying, prioritizing, and citing the most current and authoritative brand content.

Dense filings and reports that lack HTML alternatives or enhanced markup cannot be cited directly by AI, summary versions from third-party aggregators fill that gap instead, on their own terms.

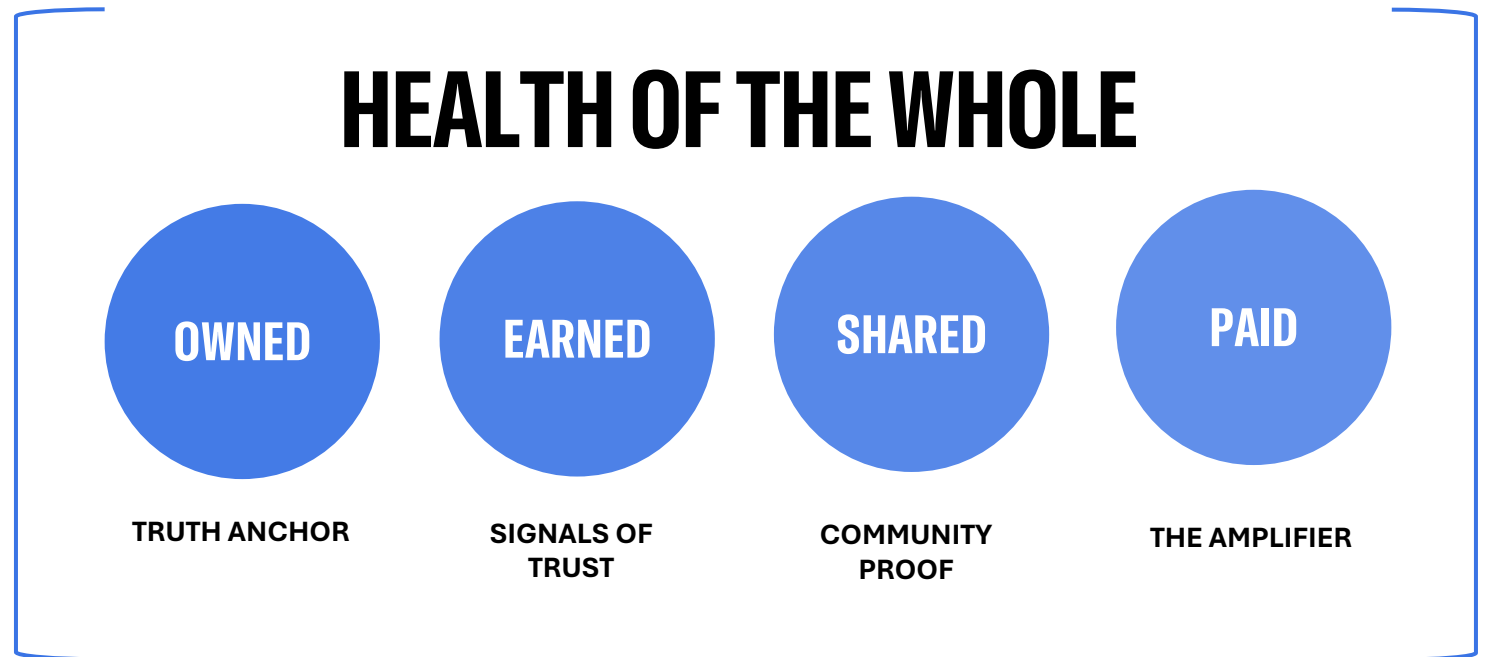
Without pre-synthesized narrative that connects financial data to corporate story, AI assembles that connection independently, drawing from raw, disconnected sources rather than the brand's own framing of its performance.



AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: RECOMMENDATIONS

INTEGRATED RECOMMENDATIONS

The following recommendations are built around a single principle: AI draws from every channel simultaneously. **Owned** anchors the truth. **Earned** validates it. **Shared** amplifies sentiment. **Paid** extends reach into credible editorial environments. Everything from media presence, PR, traditional SEO, on-site content, and technical alignment is important. Each is designed to strengthen the system, as that is how AI evaluates authority.



OWNED: TECHNICAL

Technical recommendations that can be implemented on the Bath & Body Works corporate site.

AI platforms determine source authority through underlying site architecture — schema markup, cross-domain signals, and content freshness indicators. When these foundations are underdeveloped or siloed, AI defaults to third-party sources to construct the brand's narrative on its behalf.

SCHEMA & STRUCTURED DATA

JSON-LD markup across pillar pages and the newsroom clearly shows AI how your content is organized, who wrote it, and how current it is.

CROSS-DOMAIN RELATIONSHIPS

Cross-linking between bbwinc.com and investors.bbwinc.com establishes a unified source of record across the corporate ecosystem for AI platforms.

CONTENT VERSIONING & SUCCESSION

Metadata-driven version signals across corporate content direct AI from historical goals and legacy commitments to the current, validated version.

THEMATIC CONTENT RELATIONSHIPS

Taxonomy-driven fields within the CMS generate structured signals that allow AI to identify and follow relationships between related corporate content.

PDF ACCESSIBILITY FOR AI

Improving crawlability of dense filings and reports through HTML alternatives or enhanced markup so AI can cite the content directly.

OWNED: CONTENT

Content recommendations that can be implemented on the Bath & Body Works corporate site.

AI models prioritize content that directly answers the questions being asked — structured, authoritative, and designed to be cited. When owned content is written as marketing prose or locked in dense filings, AI bypasses it in favor of third-party sources that are easier to synthesize.

NEWSROOM WORKFLOW

Releases go live on the Newsroom first, featuring machine-readable summaries positioned as the primary citable source for AI platforms.

PROACTIVE CONTENT HUB

Dedicated editorial pages that address the highest-volatility queries, providing AI with an authoritative answer before it defaults to community platforms.

FINANCIAL NARRATIVE SYNTHESIS

Pre-synthesized performance pages that connect financial data to corporate narrative — framed on the brand's terms, not assembled by aggregators.

ESG & SUSTAINABILITY REFRESH

Current validated milestones and SBTi-verified progress replace the outdated goals and legacy data AI is actively citing as current.

AI-INFORMED PRODUCT CONTENT

Audit findings inform the depth and structure of product content — addressing the reasoning behind formulations, not just the ingredients themselves.

EARNED + SHARED

Earned and shared channel strategic adjustments that can be built out by the Bath & Body Works team.

When AI encounters qualitative questions — product opinions, brand sentiment, consumer experience — it shifts authority away from corporate domains and looks for consensus across the broader landscape. Shaping that external ecosystem requires a disciplined strategy that influences perception without directly engaging in it.

WIRE STRATEGY & DISTRIBUTION

Structured backlinks on every wire release route citation authority back to the Newsroom, reducing exposure to third-party noise in AI results.

EDITORIAL PLACEMENT STRATEGY

Earned media coverage in trusted lifestyle and trade publications helps establish more credible authority than community opinions in AI-generated responses.

COMMUNITY INTELLIGENCE WORKFLOW

Shared platform monitoring surfaces emerging narratives and informs the owned content team on where to publish timely, authoritative responses.

REFERENCE & REVIEW MANAGEMENT

The brand's presence on trusted reference and review platforms is monitored to ensure the information is accurate, up to date, and properly sourced.

PAID

Paid Media recommendations that can be considered across the broader Bath & Body Works ecosystem.

AI models crawl the open web broadly and do not cleanly distinguish between organic editorial and high-quality sponsored content. Strategic paid media positions controlled, structured narratives directly within the environments AI already indexes when building responses around consumer sentiment and product perception.

NATIVE CONTENT STRATEGY

Paid placements on high-trust publisher networks introduce brand narrative into the environments AI references for qualitative consumer questions.

EDITORIAL PARTNERSHIP & SPONSORSHIP

Partnerships that generate high-ranking recommendation and listicle content position the brand within the datasets AI synthesizes for product queries.

PAID CONTENT AMPLIFICATION

Owned editorial reach extended through paid distribution into the publisher networks AI already treats as credible consensus sources.

WORKFLOWS

1

ONGOING BRAND MONITORING

Repeatable SEO and GEO analysis establishing the health baseline for Bath & Body Works — tracking organic rankings, keyword visibility, and technical site performance alongside AI citation sources, narrative accuracy, and source authority.

2

PRIORITY-LED ANALYSIS

SEO and GEO analysis timed to Bath & Body Works' launch calendar and corporate priorities — measuring organic search performance and AI narrative framing before, during, and after key moments go live.

3

COMMUNITY SIGNAL TRACKING

Monitoring community sentiment, brand mentions, and user-generated content performance across both search and AI — informing content strategy and response priorities as narratives emerge and evolve.



AI VISIBILITY AUDIT: NEXT STEPS



NEXT STEPS

**MON, 4/13 -
FRI, 4/17**

BBW to review and provide any additional questions or points needing clarification.

BY FRI, 4/24

BBW to evaluate recommendations and confirm direction for scope and next phase of work.

PYARD

SHIPYARD

SHIPYA

PYARD

SHIPYARD

SHIPYA

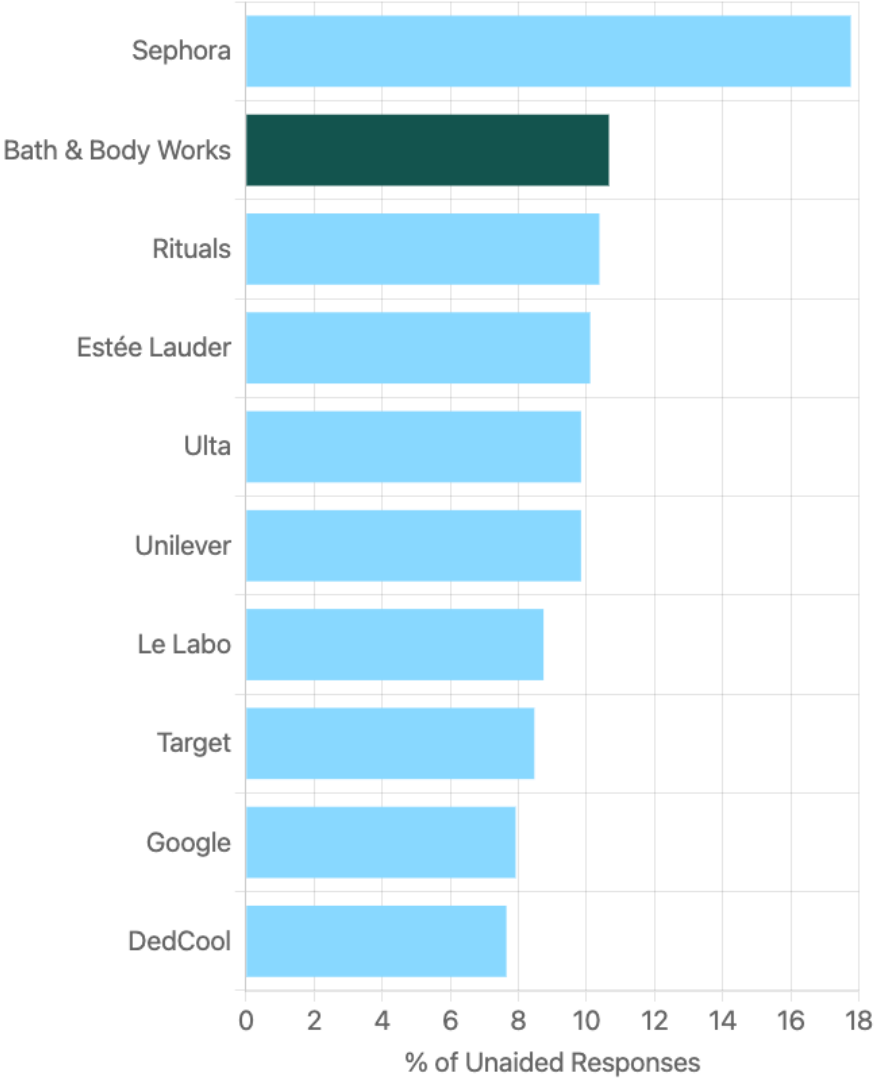
PYARD

SHIPYARD

SHIPYA

Top 10 Brands by Mention Rate (unaided)

BBW Rank: #2 | % of responses mentioning each brand



Top 10 Brands by Citation Rate (unaided)

Which brands AI trusts as authoritative sources

